

Industry News

India approves its first solar power plan

As part of the National Action Plan on Climate Change, the cabinet has approved Rs 43,370 million for solar mission plan to increase the solar power production from the current capacity of 6 MW (megawatts) to 20,000 MW by 2022. The plan will be executed in three phases. In the first phase, to be executed between 2010 and 2013, an area of 7 million square metres will be covered with solar collectors to produce 200 MW of off-grid solar power.

The plan also aims at providing solar lighting systems to 9000 villages by facilitating soft loans through banks.

Under the plan, NTPC Vidyut Vyapar Nigam Limited will act as the nodal agency to buy solar power from producers at the rate recently fixed by Central Electricity Regulatory Commission.

PC shipments to grow 2.8 per cent in 2009

Mobile PC shipments will drive the worldwide PC market to grow again this year, as per Gartner's preliminary fourth-quarter forecast. The report says that the worldwide PC shipments will total 298.9 million units in 2009, a 2.8 per cent increase from 2008. In 2010, PC shipments are projected to reach 336.6 million units, a 12.6 per cent increase over 2009.

While PC shipments are expected to increase in 2009, the market value of PC shipments is still projected to decline. The market value of global PC shipments is now forecast to be a total \$217 billion in 2009, a 10.7 per cent decline from 2008.

Lead poisoning risk linked to computers' sales

The planned distribution of a billion computers by major IT companies and charities will cause a widespread lead

Ravi Aggarwal is new MAIT president

MAIT has appointed Ravi Aggarwal, president, imaging and printing group, Hewlett Packard India Sales as its new president. Also Sandeep Nair, managing director, Emerson Network Power (India) has taken over as its vice president for the term 2009-10.

Veeraraghavan takes over as director, VSSC

P.S. Veeraraghavan, distinguished scientist of ISRO and director, ISRO Inertial Systems Unit (IISU), assumed the office of director at Vikram Sarabhai

Space Centre (VSSC). He replaces Dr K. Radhakrishnan who has succeeded Dr G. Madhavan Nair as ISRO chairman.

Hari Narayanan joins Mahindra Satyam

Mahindra Satyam has appointed Hari Narayanan as head of new business development in Japan. Hari will be responsible to lead a team and drive business development across emerging technologies growing Mahindra Satyam's presence in the automotive, manufacturing, banking and financial services industries. He will be reporting to Raghavendra Tripathi, regional manager for North Asia.

poisoning in developing countries, says a study. The threat comes from the lead used in batteries, which may cause environmental contamination, unless some safeguards are taken, the study adds.

Independent market projections indicate that one billion computers are to be sold, leased or donated by computer companies such as Intel, Microsoft and AMD, and philanthropic groups including the Gates Foundation, over the next six years. These companies and foundations are targeting rural areas of developing countries primarily in Asia and Africa for expansion.

The study, 'Plans to Distribute the Next Billion Computers by 2015 Creates Pollution Risk,' explains that India alone is expected to gain 150 million new PC users by 2015 and most will use lead batteries for backup power.

Govt approves policy to digitise cable TV

The government has approved guidelines for Headend-in-the-Sky (HITS) broadcasting service that will provide digitised cable content to viewers across the country. HITS will provide subscribers with a wider choice of

digital channels, better picture quality and value-added services at affordable prices.

HITS is expected to give impetus to the digitalisation of cable services in non-conditional access system areas of the country and increase the penetration of cable market into rural areas. It will also help in further reduction of prices of set-top boxes and lead to further consolidation of the cable market.

The HITS policy does not mandate for either the cable operators or subscribers to necessarily obtain signals from a HITS platform/network. The subscribers and cable operators can continue with the existing system.

Moser Baer to invest Rs 23,000 crore in manufacturing plants

Moser Baer Photo Voltaic, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Moser Baer India, plans to invest nearly Rs 23,000 million in its manufacturing facilities in Chennai and Hyderabad over the next 10 years. The funds may be used to build new capacities for photovoltaic cells. However, the expansion of Moser Baer's Noida plant is being delayed due to the global slowdown.

In Focus